ALLAMAHUL BAYAN SERIES · BOOK 18

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

My First Kashmiri Alphabet

کأشُر اَلِف بے

A Coloring Book to Learn, Trace & Say the 37 Kashmiri Letters with English Phonetics

ا ب پ ت ژ س

Written by Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza

Illustrations: AI-assisted, edited by the author

Maktabatu Kunujul Akhirah

مكتبة كنوز الآخرة

REVIEW DRAFT — not for publication

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My First Kashmiri Alphabet — کأشُر اَلِف بے
Allamahul Bayan Series, Book 18

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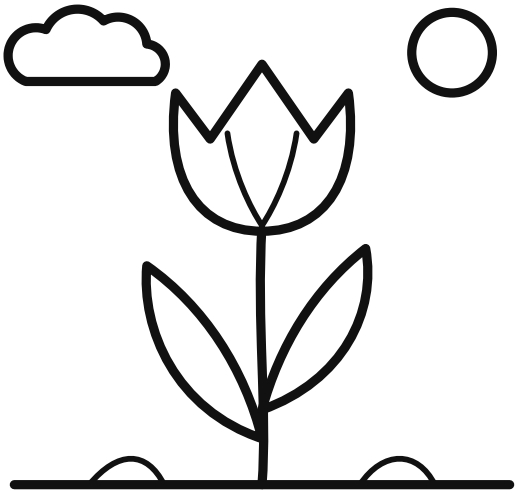
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Illustrations: line art created with AI assistance and reviewed by the author. In keeping with the publisher's guidelines, the pictures show objects, plants and nature only — no people or animals.

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A note of respect: this book contains verses of the Noble Qur'an (pages 4–5). Please handle it with care and keep it in a clean place.

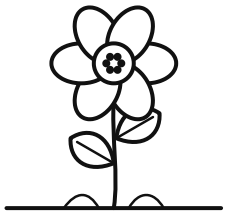


This book belongs to
یہ کِتاب چھےٚ میأنٕ

I started learning Kashmiri on







ABOUT THIS SERIES

The Allamahul Bayan Series

عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ

ʿallamahul-bayān — "He taught him clear expression"

الرَّحْمَٰنُ ﴿١﴾ عَلَّمَ الْقُرْآنَ ﴿٢﴾ خَلَقَ الْإِنسَانَ ﴿٣﴾ عَلَّمَهُ الْبَيَانَ ﴿٤﴾

Ar-Raḥmān. ʿAllamal-Qurʾān. Khalaqal-insān. ʿAllamahul-bayān.

"The Most Merciful. He taught the Qur'an. He created the human being. He taught him clear expression (al-bayān)."

Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4[1]

Surah Ar-Raḥmān — the chapter of *The Most Merciful* — opens by naming some of Allah's greatest gifts to us. First, **He taught the Qur'an**. Then, **He created the human being**. And then, **He taught him al-bayān**.

What does *al-bayān* mean? It comes from an Arabic root that means *to make something clear*. Al-bayān is the gift of speech and understanding: being able to put what is in our hearts and minds into words, to explain, to listen, and to be understood. Animals make sounds, but only people were taught to speak, read and write in languages. Scholars of tafsīr explain that this gift is what lets us learn, teach and pass on guidance — including the Qur'an itself.

So every time a child says a new word, sounds out a letter, or writes their first line in a new language, they are using a gift that Allah Himself says He taught. That is the heart of this series: **learning languages as a way of thanking Allah for al-bayān.**

Languages and colours: two signs of Allah

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ خَلْقُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَاخْتِلَافُ أَلْسِنَتِكُمْ وَأَلْوَانِكُمْ ۚ إِنَّ فِي ذَٰلِكَ لَآيَاتٍ لِّلْعَالِمِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾

Wa min āyātihī khalqus-samāwāti wal-arḍi wakh-tilāfu alsinatikum wa alwānikum. Inna fī dhālika la-āyātil-lil-ʿālimīn.

"And among His signs is the creation of the heavens and the earth, and the variety of your languages and your colours. Surely in that are signs for those who know."

Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22[1]

In Surah Ar-Rūm, Allah tells us that the **many languages** of people and their **many colours** are among His signs. A coloring book that teaches a language brings both of these signs together in a child's hands: they meet a new language, and they fill its letters with colour.

وَجَعَلْنَاكُمْ شُعُوبًا وَقَبَائِلَ لِتَعَارَفُوا

Wa jaʿalnākum shuʿūban wa qabāʾila li-taʿārafū.

"...and We made you into peoples and tribes so that you may get to know one another."

Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13 (part)[1]

Allah made us into many peoples *so that we may get to know one another*. Learning even a few letters of someone's language is a beautiful first step towards knowing them.

How each book in the series works

Every book introduces one language **through English**:

- where the language is spoken, with a map to color;
- every letter of its alphabet, with its name in the language itself *and* in English letters;
- simple English sound guides, so a parent who has never heard the language can still help;
- a word and picture for every letter, to color, trace and say out loud.

Book 18 is Kashmiri. More languages from around the world are in the series, in shā' Allāh.

FOR PARENTS AND TEACHERS

How to use this book

Begin with **Bismillah**, and go **little and often**: one letter a day is plenty for a young child. For each letter:

1. **Say it.** Read the letter's name and its sound guide together. Say it three times.
2. **Color it.** Color the big letter any way your child likes.
3. **Trace it.** Trace the dotted letters with a pencil, then try one alone in the empty boxes.
4. **Meet the word.** Say the word, color the picture, and talk about it in English.

Marker tip: every coloring page has a blank back, so colours cannot spoil the next activity. Slip a sheet of scrap paper behind the page you are coloring anyway — it keeps the next page clean.

Reading the English sound guides

- **Kashmiri is read from right to left**, like the Qur'an. The tracing rows on each page also start on the right.
- **Doubled vowels are long:** *aa* as in "father", *ee* as in "see", *oo* as in "moon".
- **A dot under t and d** (*ṭ*, *ḍ*) means a *hard* sound with the tongue curled back; without the dot the tongue touches the back of the top teeth.
- **ts** is one sound, as at the end of "cats": Kashmiri writes it with ژ.
- **Some letters sound the same** (ث س ص all say *s*; ذ ز ض ظ all say *z*). They keep their Arabic spelling, which helps when children later read the Qur'an.
- Kashmiri has a few vowels English does not have. The guides use the nearest English sound — listen to a Kashmiri speaker if you can.

Three ways to see every sound

Each letter page shows the sound three ways: the letter's **Kashmiri name** written in Kashmiri (native phonetics), the **same name in English letters**, and an **English sound guide**. Because Kashmiri letters **change shape** when they join, the third box shows the letter at the start, middle and end of a word (letters that never join to the next letter are marked). The extra Kashmiri vowel marks are explained on the page before the letters.

The pronunciation guides are simplified for young learners and follow Kashmiri as spoken in the Kashmir Valley.

MEET THE LANGUAGE

Hello, Kashmiri! کأشُر

koshur — the Kashmiri word for the language

Who speaks it?
About **7 million people** speak Kashmiri.[3] Its own name for itself is کأشُر *koshur*.

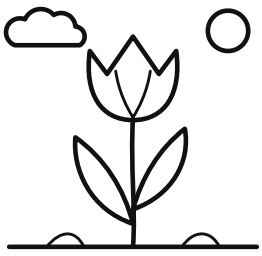
Where?
In the **Kashmir Valley** and nearby valleys, high in the **Himalaya mountains**, around the city of **Srinagar**. Kashmiri families also live in many other places.

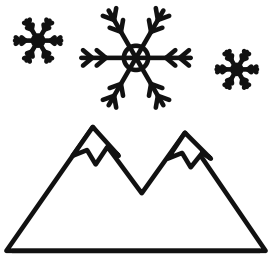
How is it written?
From **right to left**, in a Perso-Arabic script, usually in the flowing **Nastaliq** style. Some people also write it in Devanagari.

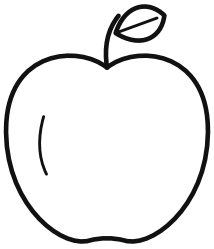
How many letters?
This book teaches **37 letters**, plus the special **vowel marks** that make Kashmiri different from Urdu and Persian (اٗ ۄ ۍ ے).

A land of flowers
Kashmir is famous for its **tulips**, its tall **chinar trees**, its almonds and apples, and its lakes and snowy mountains.

Warm in winter
In the cold winter, people carry a کانگر *kaangir*, a little clay pot of warm embers in a wicker basket, and drink salty pink *noon chai*.







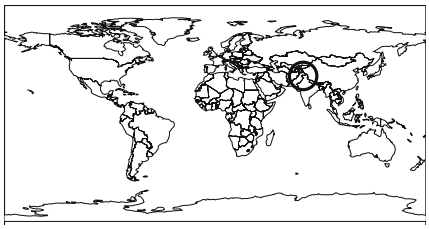
THE WHOLE ALPHABET

The Kashmiri Alphabet اَلِف بے

37 letters – اَلِف بے

ج *jeem*	ث *se*	ٹ *ṭe*	ت *te*	پ *pe*	ب *be*	ا *alif*
ر *re*	ذ *zaal*	ڈ *ḍaal*	د *daal*	خ *khe*	ح *he*	چ *che*
ط *to'e*	ض *zu'aad*	ص *su'aad*	ش *sheen*	س *seen*	ژ *tse*	ز *ze*
گ *gaaf*	ک *kaaf*	ق *qaaf*	ف *fe*	غ *ghain*	ع *ain*	ظ *zo'e*
ء *hamza*	ھ *do-chashmi he*	ہ *he*	و *vaav*	ن *noon*	م *meem*	ل *laam*
					ے *boḍ ye*	ی *ye*

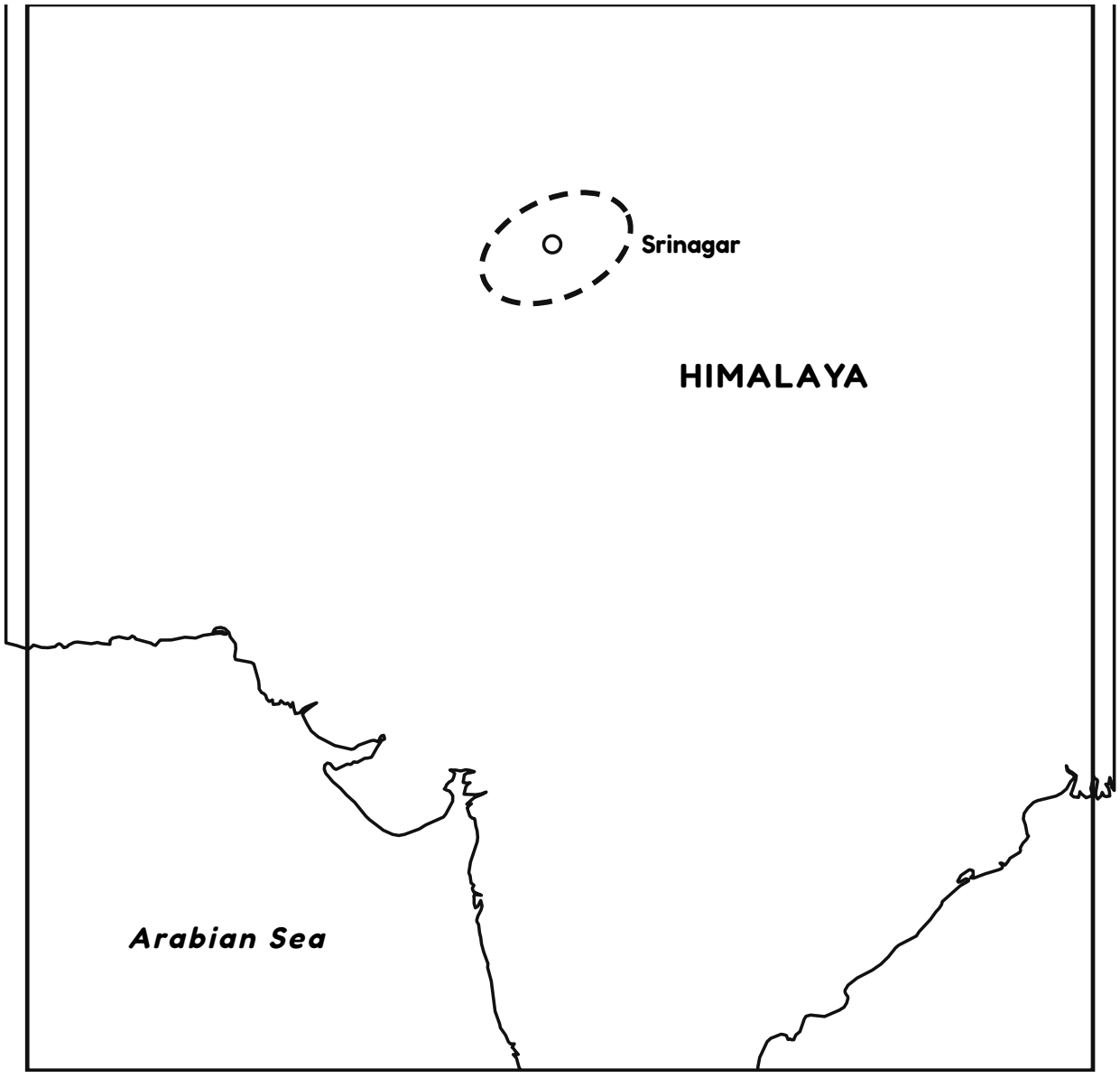
Read the alphabet from **right to left**, row by row — the same order as in this book.



The circle shows the Kashmir Valley on the world map.

COLOR THE MAP

Where is Kashmiri spoken?



Color it: the land **green** · the sea **blue** · the high snowy mountains **white**. **Find it:** the dashed line goes around the Kashmir Valley, where Kashmiri is spoken. Srinagar is its biggest city, beside Dal Lake.

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THE LETTERS

The Kashmiri Letters اَلِف بے

alif be — "the A-B-C"

Kashmiri is written **from right to left**. Open your book at any letter page and start reading on the right!

Letters hold hands

Most letters **join** to the letter after them and change shape a little. Each letter page shows the shapes at the start, middle and end of a word.

baadaam (almonds) بادام = م + ا + د + ا + ب

Kashmiri vowel marks

Kashmiri has more vowel sounds than Urdu, so it uses some **extra little marks** above and below the letters. Books for grown-ups often leave them out; children's books keep them.

بَ	**zabar** (line above): short 'a' as in "cup"
بِ	**zer** (line below): short 'i' as in "sit"
بُ	**pesh** (curl above): short 'u' as in "put"
بٕ	**hamza below**: a short sound between 'i' and 'u'
بٔ	**hamza above**: a short 'uh'

كأشُر	أ alif with a wavy hamza: a long, deep 'uh', as in *koshur* (Kashmiri)
زوٗن	وٗ: long 'oo', as in *zoon* (moon)
شپِن	یِ: long 'ee', as in *sheen* (snow)
وٚ ىٚ	وٚ (ring): 'o' as in "hot" · ىٚ (little v): 'e' as in "bed"
سِرۍ	ۍ at the end of a word: a tiny 'y' breath, as in *siry* (sun)

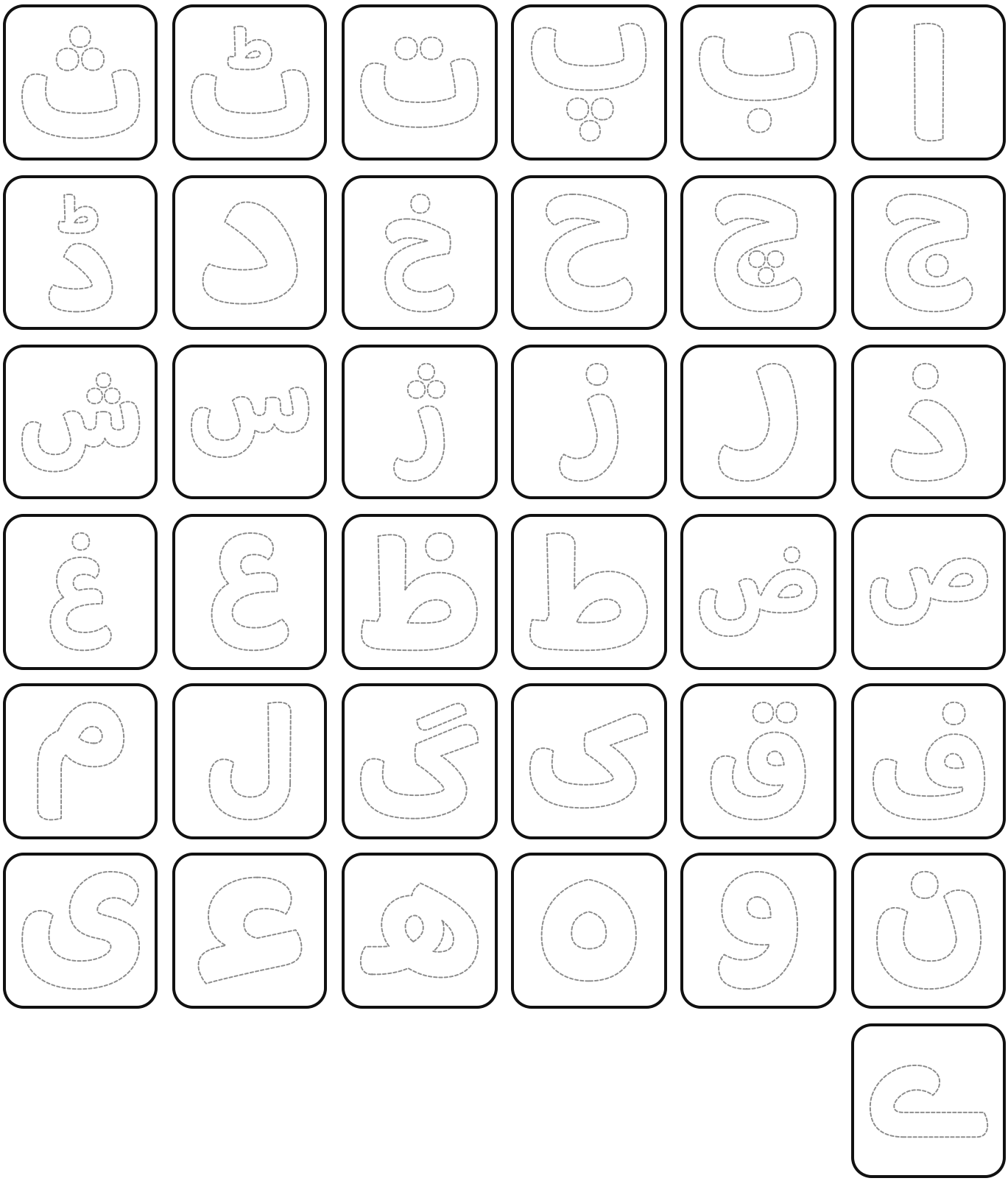
Ten letters never join forward

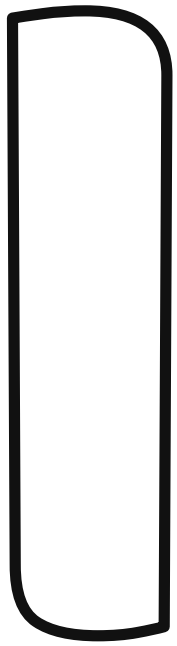
ء و ژ ز ر ذ ڈ د ا (and the final ے) join to the letter *before* them, but never to the one after.

PENCIL WARM-UP

Trace the letters اَلِف بے

Use a **pencil**. Say each letter's name as you trace it.





NAME · ناو

اَلِف

alif

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

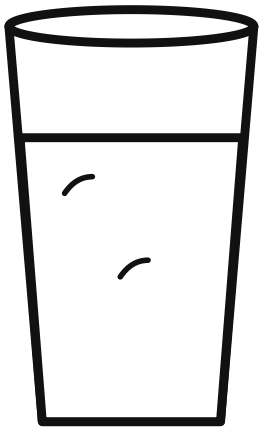
‘a’ or ‘aa’ — a long ‘aa’ as in “father” inside a word

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ا · after a letter ـا

It never joins to the letter after it.

With a little wave on top, آ says a long ‘aa’ at the start of a word.



ا IS FOR

آب

aab

water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

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ب

NAME · ناو

بے

be

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘b’ as in “ball”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

بـ ـبـ ـب

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

One dot below.



ب IS FOR

بادام

baadaam

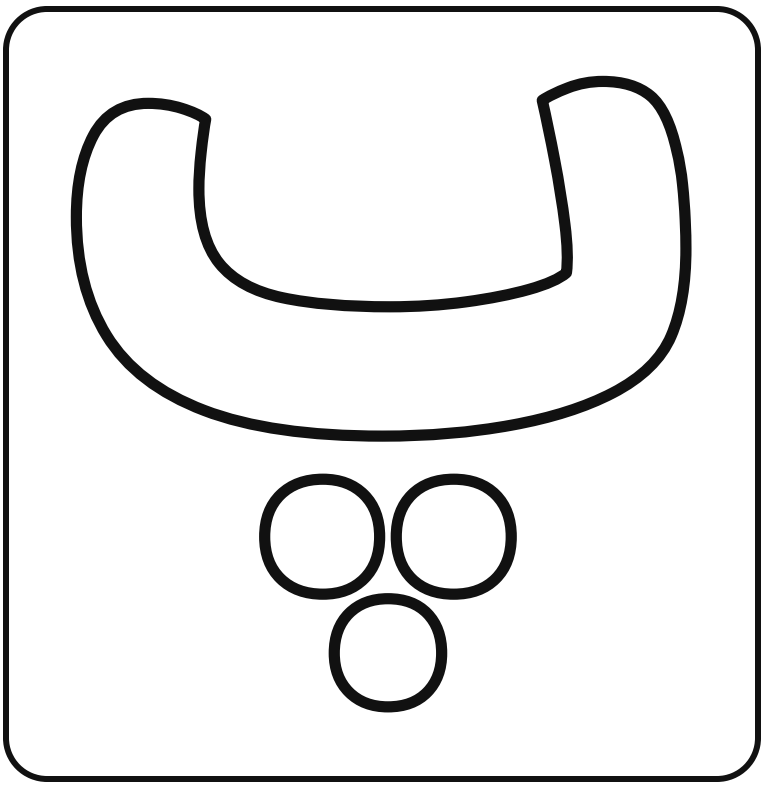
almonds

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ب ب ب ب

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NAME · ناو

پے

pe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

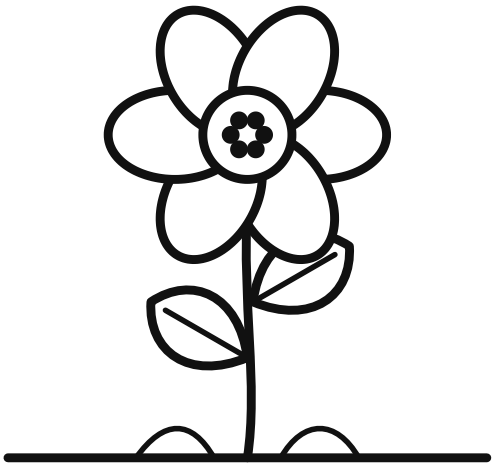
‘p’ as in “pen”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

پـ ـپـ ـپ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Three dots below.



پ IS FOR

پوش

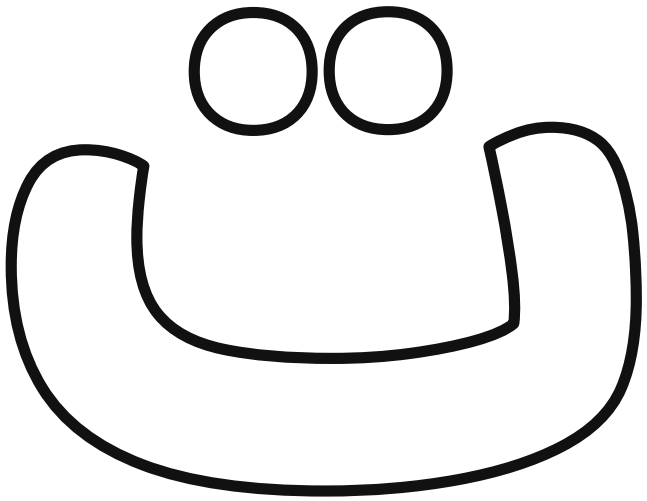
posh

flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

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NAME · ناو

تے

te

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

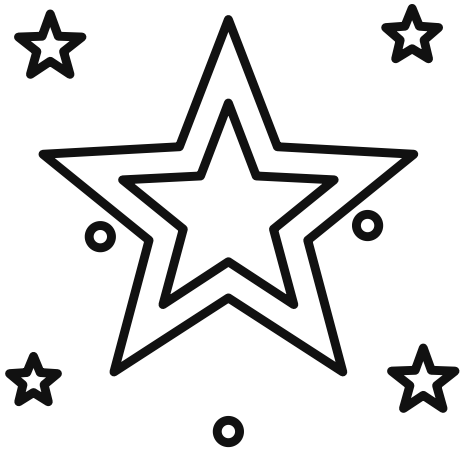
a soft ‘t’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

تـ ـتـ ـت

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Two dots above.



ت IS FOR

تارُکھ

taarukh

star

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

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NAME · ناو

ٹے

ṭe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

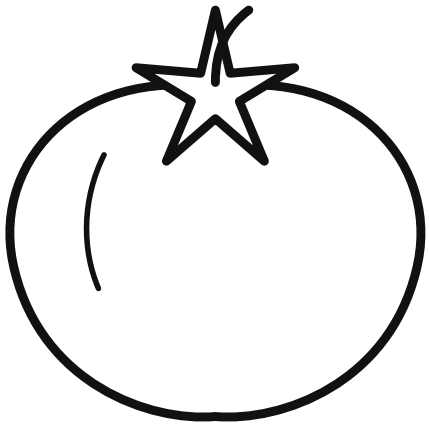
a hard ‘t’ — curl your tongue back, as in “top”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ٹ ـٹـ ـٹ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

A little ‘ṭ’ sign on top.



ٹ IS FOR

ٹماٹر

ṭamaaṭar

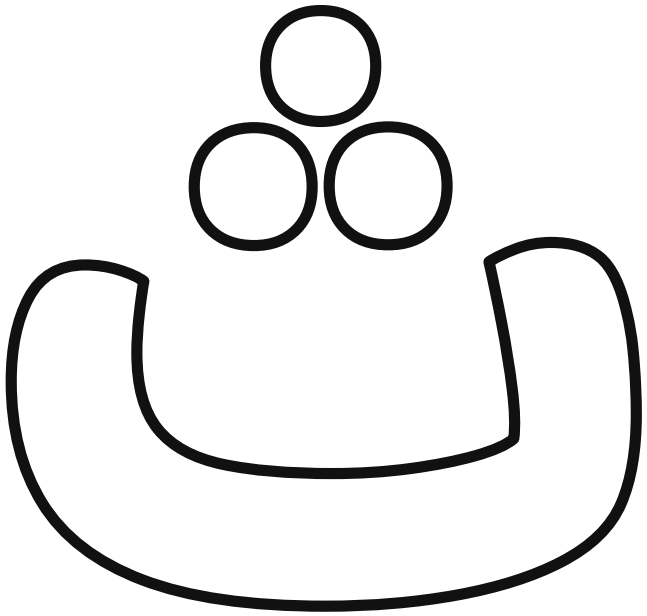
tomato

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ٹ ٹ ٹ ٹ

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NAME · ناو

ثے

se

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ثـ ـثـ ـث

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Sounds the same as س; it is used mostly in words from Arabic and Persian.



ث IS FOR

ثَمَر

samar

fruit

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ث ث ث ث

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ج

NAME · ناو

جیم

jeem

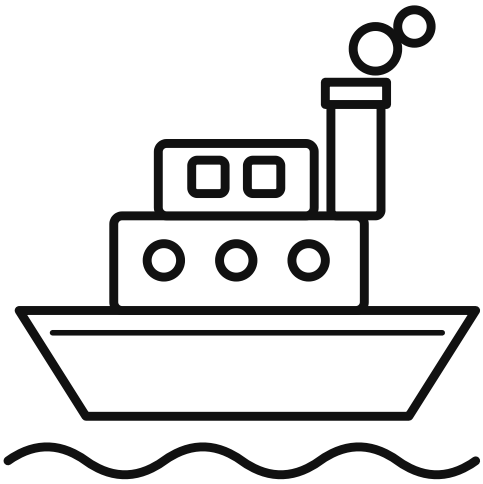
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘j’ as in “jam”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

جـ ـجـ ـج

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ج IS FOR

جہاز

jahaaz

ship

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ج ج ج

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چ

NAME · ناو

چے

che

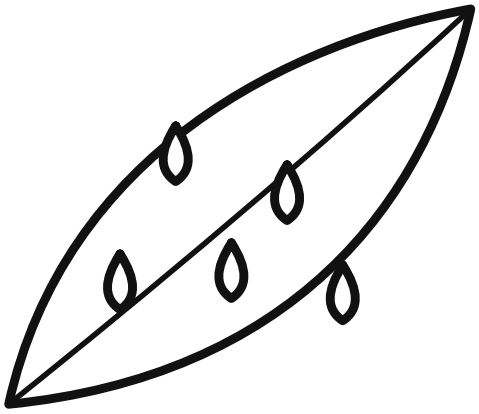
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘ch’ as in “chair”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

چ ـچـ ـچ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



چ IS FOR

چَشمہٕ

chashma

spring of water

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

چ چ چ چ

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ح

NAME · ناو

ح

he

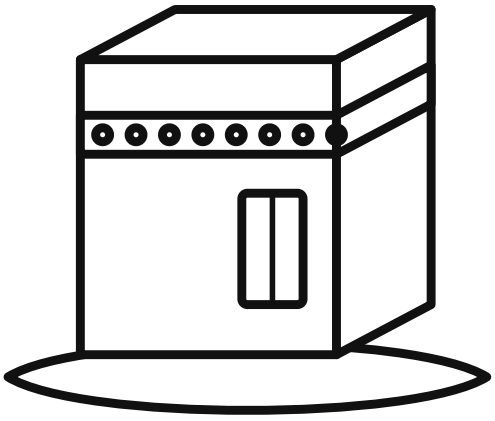
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ح ـحـ ـح

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ح IS FOR

حج

hajj

Hajj, the journey to the Kaaba in Makkah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ح ح ح

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خ

NAME · ناو

خے

khe

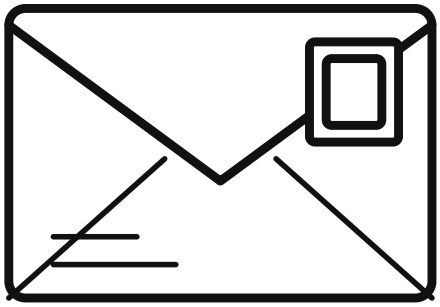
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a scratchy ‘kh’ from the back of the throat, as in Scottish “loch”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

خ ـخـ ـخ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



خ IS FOR

خط

khat

letter (that you post)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

خ خ خ

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د

NAME · ناو

دال

daal

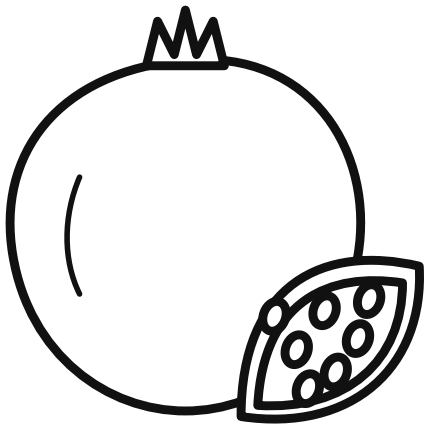
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft ‘d’ — tongue touches the back of the teeth

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone **د** · after a letter **ـد**

It never joins to the letter after it.



د IS FOR

دان

daan

pomegranate

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

د د د د

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ڈ

NAME · ناو

ڈال

ḍaal

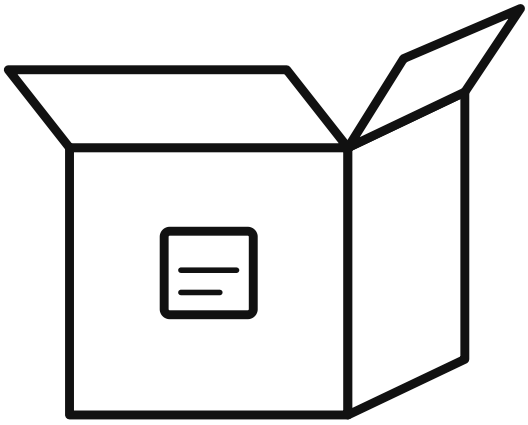
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a hard ‘d’ — curl your tongue back, as in “dog”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ڈ · after a letter ـڈ

It never joins to the letter after it.



ڈ IS FOR

ڈَبہٕ

ḍabba

box

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ڈ ڈ ڈ ڈ

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ذ

NAME · ناو

ذال

zaal

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

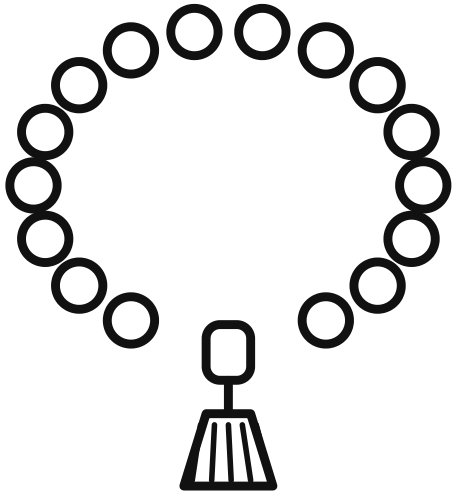
‘z’ as in “zoo”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ذ · after a letter ـذ

It never joins to the letter after it.

Sounds the same as ز; it is used mostly in words from Arabic and Persian.



ذ IS FOR

ذِكر

zikr

dhikr — remembering Allah

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ذ ذ ذ ذ

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ر

NAME · ناو

رے

re

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a tapped ‘r’ — flick the tongue once

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ر · after a letter ـر

It never joins to the letter after it.



ر IS FOR

رۄد

rood

rain

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ر ر ر ر

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ز

NAME · ناو

زے

ze

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘z’ as in “zoo”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone **ز** · after a letter **ـز**

It never joins to the letter after it.



ز IS FOR

زوٗن

zoon

moon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ز ز ز ز

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ژ

NAME · ناو

ژے

tse

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

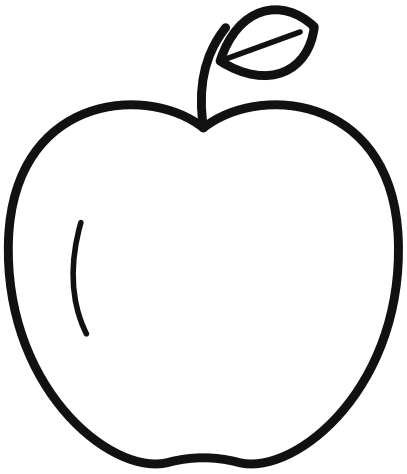
‘ts’ as in “cats” — in Kashmiri this letter is **not** ‘zh’!

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ژ · after a letter ـژ

It never joins to the letter after it.

Three dots on ز. In Urdu and Persian it says ‘zh’, but in Kashmiri it says ‘ts’.



ژ IS FOR

ژۄنٹھ

tsoonṭh

apple

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ژ ژ ژ ژ

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س

NAME · ناو

سِين

seen

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

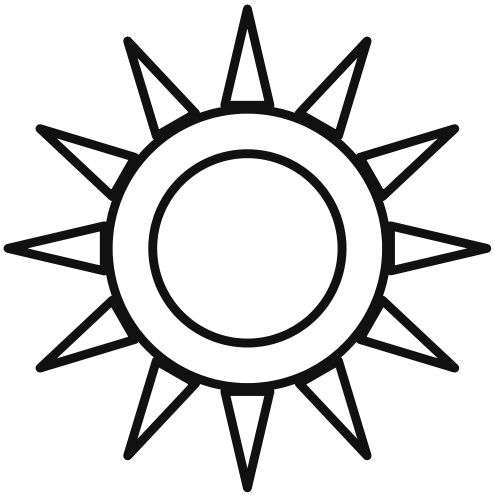
‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

سـ ـسـ ـس س

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Look at the end of سِرِي: the special Kashmiri ي adds a tiny ‘y’ breath.



س IS FOR

سِرِي

siry

sun

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

س س س س س

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ش

NAME · ناو

شِین

sheen

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

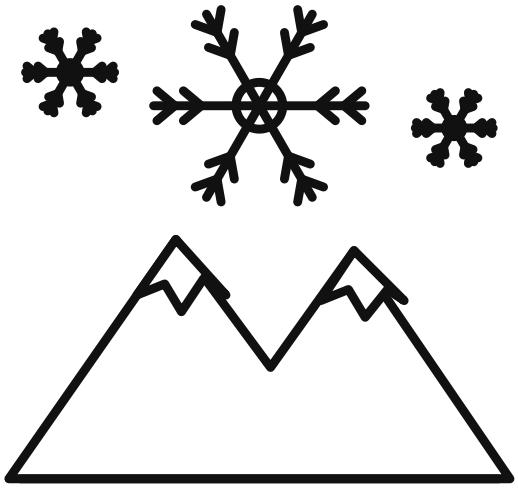
‘sh’ as in “shoe”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

شـ ـشـ ـش

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

The letter’s name and the word for snow sound the same!



ش IS FOR

شپن

sheen

snow

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ش ش ش ش

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ص

NAME · ناو

صاد

su’aad

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

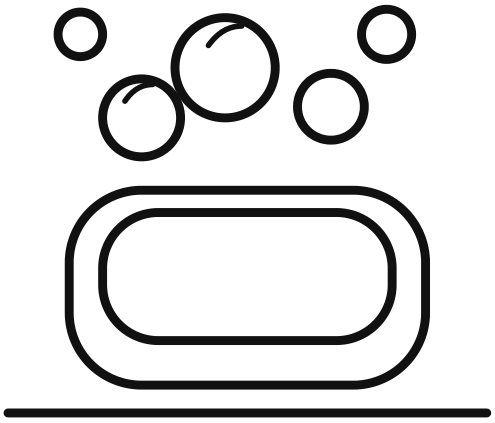
‘s’ as in “sun”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

صـ ـصـ ـص

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Sounds the same as س; it is used mostly in words from Arabic and Persian.



ص IS FOR

صابَن

saaban

soap

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ص ص ص ص

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ض

NAME · ناو

ضاد

zu'aad

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

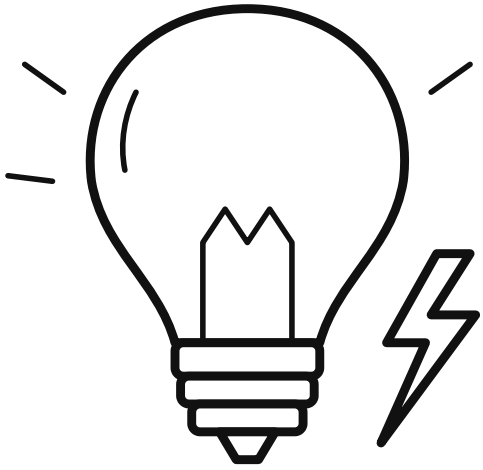
'z' as in "zoo"

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ضـ ـضـ ـض

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Sounds the same as ز; it is used mostly in words from Arabic and Persian.



ض IS FOR

ضیا

ziyaa

light

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ض ض ض ض

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ط

NAME · ناو

طوے

to'e

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft 't', like ت

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ط ـطـ ـط

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Sounds the same as ت; it is used mostly in words from Arabic and Persian.



ط IS FOR

طَشت

tasht

washing basin (with its jug)

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ط ط ط ط

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ظ

NAME · ناو

ظوے

zo'e

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

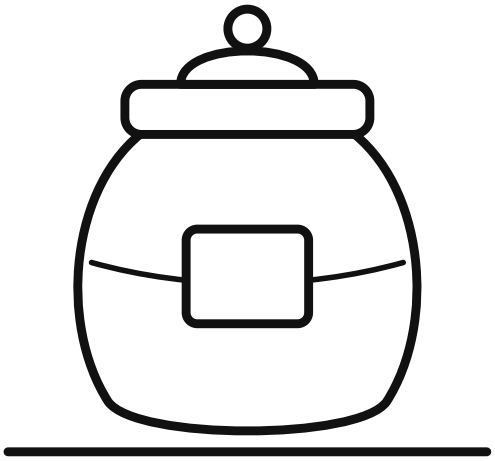
'z' as in "zoo"

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ظـ ـظـ ـظ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Sounds the same as ز; it is used mostly in words from Arabic and Persian.



ظ IS FOR

ظَرف

zarf

container, jar

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ظ ظ ظ ظ

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ع

NAME · ناو

عین

ain

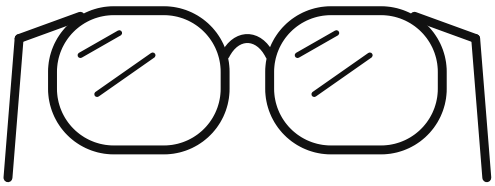
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

in Kashmiri, just the vowel next to it — in Arabic, a sound from deep in the throat

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

عـ ـعـ ـع

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ع IS FOR

عینَک

ainak

glasses

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ع ع ع ع

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غ

NAME · ناو

غين

ghain

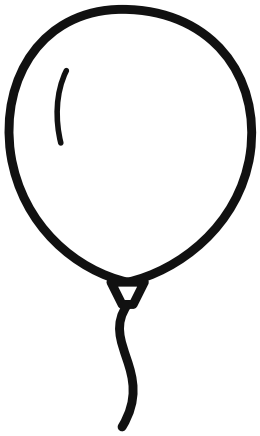
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a soft gargled ‘gh’ from the back of the throat

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

غـ ـغـ ـغ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



غ IS FOR

غُبارہ

ghubaara

balloon

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

غ غ غ غ

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ف

NAME · ناو

ـفے

fe

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘f’ as in “fan”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

فـ ـفـ ـف

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ف IS FOR

فانوس

faanoos

lantern

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ف ف ف ف ف

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ق

NAME · ناو

قاف

qaaf

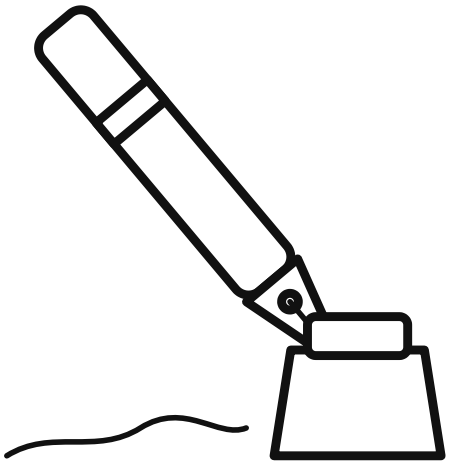
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

a ‘k’ said far back in the throat

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

قـ ـقـ ـق

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ق IS FOR

قَلَم

qalam

pen

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ق ق ق ق

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ک

NAME · ناو

کاف

kaaf

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘k’ as in “kite”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ک ـکـ ـک

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Families in Kashmir keep warm with a kangri in the snowy winter.

ک IS FOR



کانگِر

kaangir

kangri — a little clay fire-pot in a wicker basket

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ک ک ک ک

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گ

NAME · ناو

گاف

gaaf

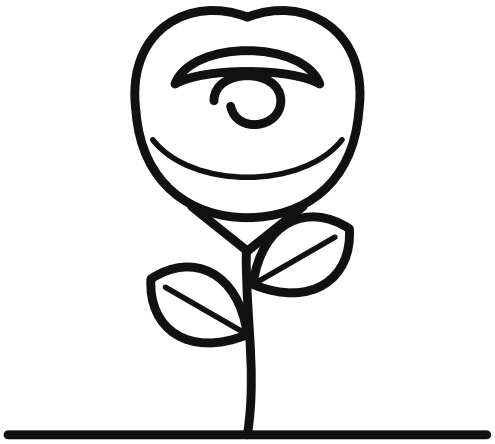
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘g’ as in “go”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

گ ـگ ـگـ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



گ IS FOR

گُلاب

gulaab

rose

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

گ گ گ

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ل

NAME · ناو

لام

laam

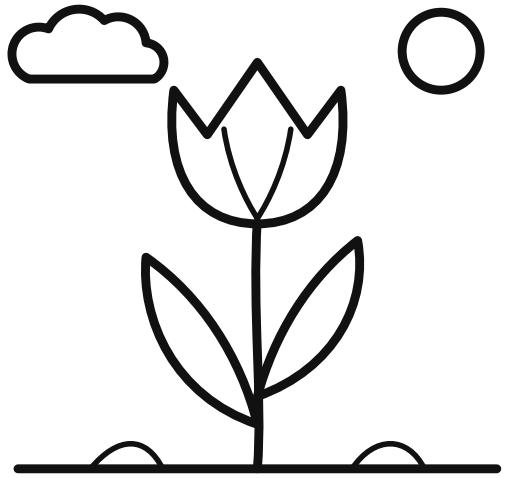
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'l' as in "lamp"

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ل ـلـ ـل

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ل IS FOR

لالہٕ

laala

tulip

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ل ل ل ل

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م

NAME · ناو

میم

meem

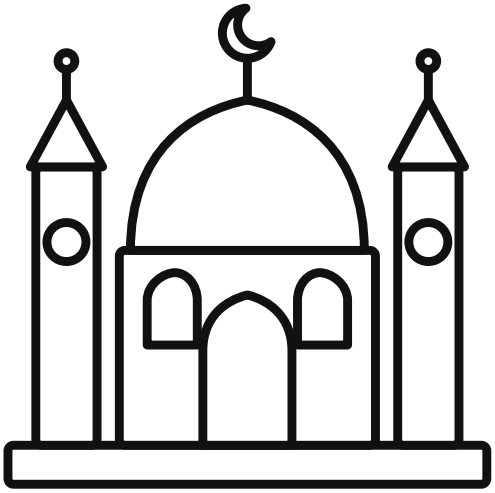
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘m’ as in “moon”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

مـ ـمـ ـم

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



م IS FOR

مَشید

masheed

mosque

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

م م م م

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ن

NAME · ناو

نوٗن

noon

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘n’ as in “net”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

نـ ـنـ ـن

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Salt is used to make *noon chai*, Kashmir’s pink salty tea.



ن IS FOR

نوٗن

noon

salt

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ن ن ن ن

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و

NAME · ناو

واو

vaav

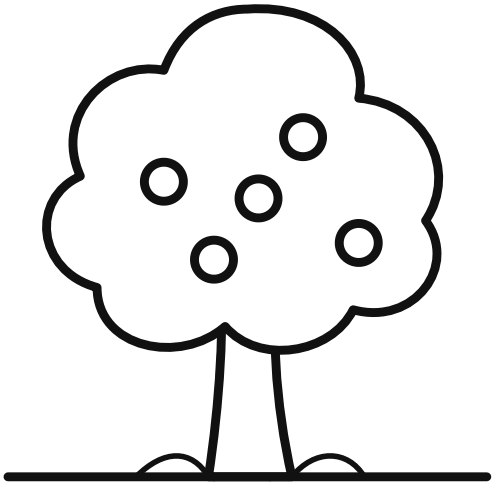
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

'v' as in "van", or the vowels 'oo' and 'o'

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone **و** · after a letter **ـو**

It never joins to the letter after it.



و IS FOR

وَن

van

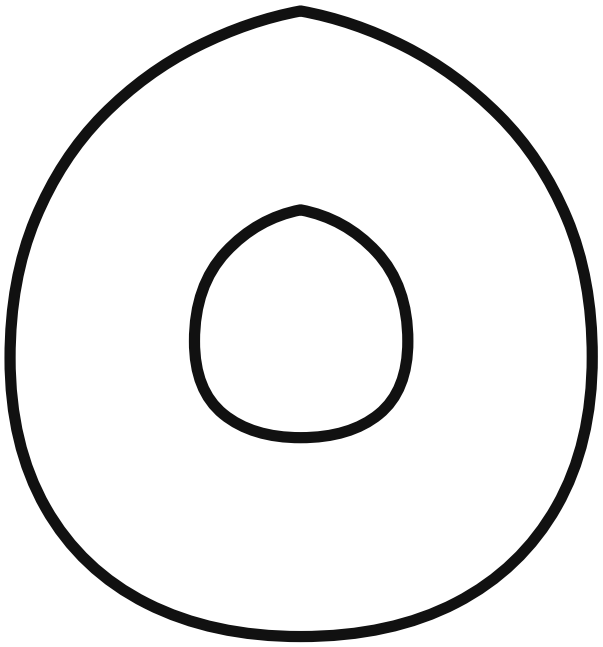
forest

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

و و و و

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NAME · ناو

ہے

he

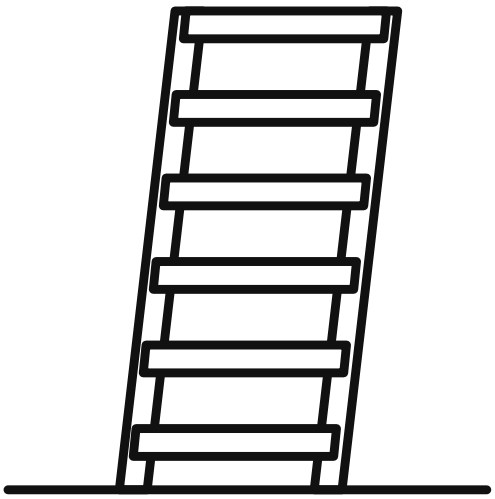
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘h’ as in “hat”

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ہ ـہـ ـہ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ہ IS FOR

ہٕیر

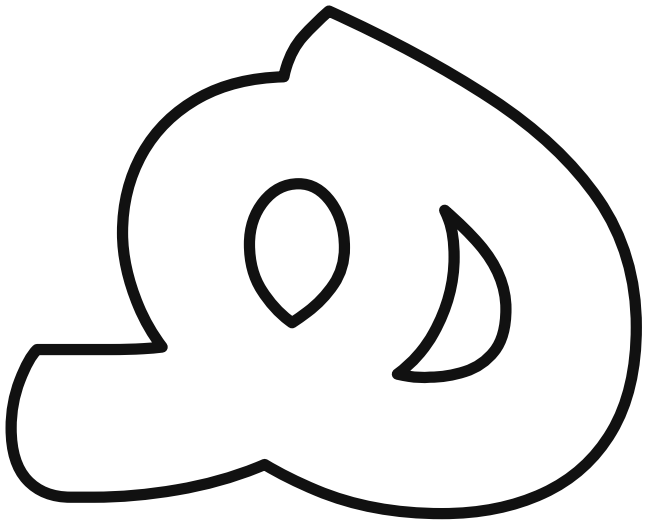
her

stairs, ladder

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

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NAME · ناو

دو چشمی ہے

do-chashmi he

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

adds a puff of breath to the letter before it: ٹھ = ھ + ٹ ‘ṭh’

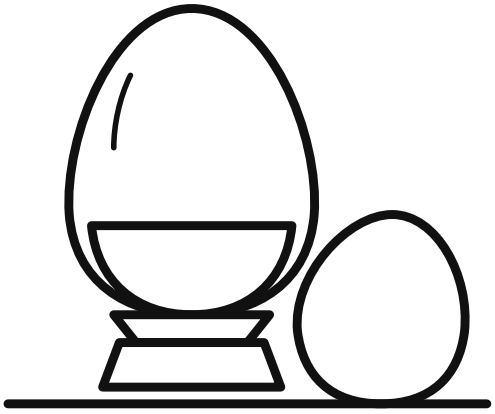
LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ھـ ـھـ ـھ

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)

Its name means “two-eyed he”.

Find ھ in ٹھوٗل — it never starts a word.



ھ IS FOR

ٹھوٗل

ṭhool

egg

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ھ ھ ھ ھ

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ع

NAME · ناو

ہَمزہ

hamza

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

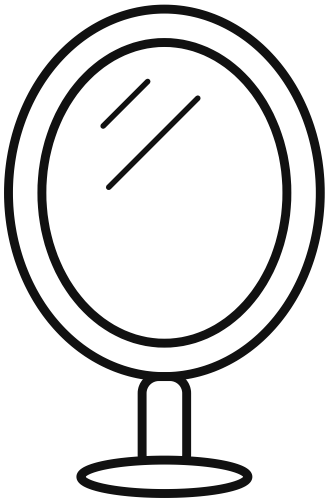
a tiny break in the voice between two vowels

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Alone ع · after a letter ـع

It never joins to the letter after it.

Find the ء sitting on its seat in آئینہ. Small hamza marks are also used as Kashmiri vowel signs.



ء IS FOR

آئینہ

aa'ina

mirror

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ع ع ع ع

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ی

NAME · ناو

یے

ye

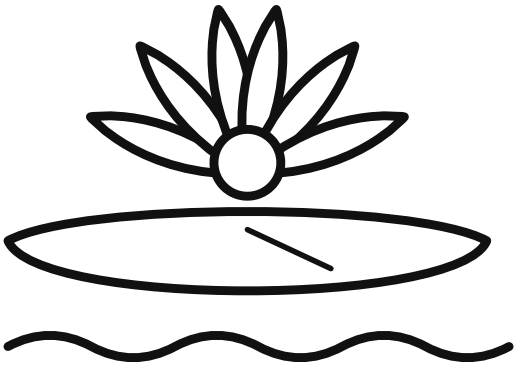
SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘y’ as in “yes”, or the long vowel ‘ee’

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

ی ـیـ ـی

start · middle · end of a word (read right to left)



ی IS FOR

ئمبرزَل

yambarzal

narcissus flower

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

ی ی ی ی

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ے

NAME · ناو

بوڈے

boḍ ye

SAY IT · ENGLISH SOUND GUIDE

‘e’ as in “they” — only at the end of a word

LETTER SHAPES · HOW IT JOINS

Joined to the letter before: ـے

Look for ـے at the end of چاے!



ے IS FOR

چاے

chaay

tea

Color the picture and say the word three times!

TRACE IT WITH A PENCIL, THEN WRITE IT ON YOUR OWN · لیکھو

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BONUS

Kashmiri numbers گَنزِر *(ganzir)*

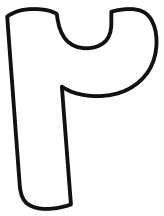
Color the numbers and count out loud in Kashmiri: *sifar*, *akh*, *zi*, *tri*...



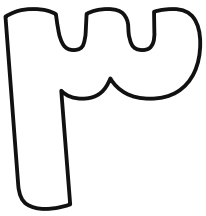
0
صِفر
sifar
zero



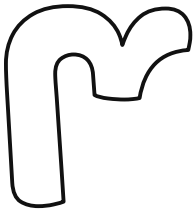
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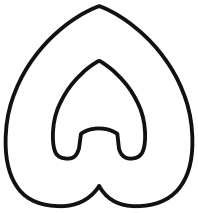
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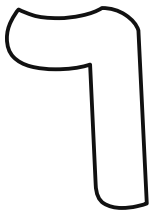
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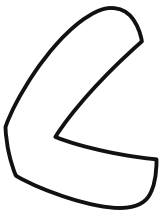
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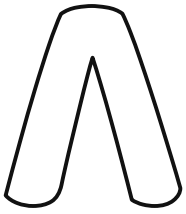
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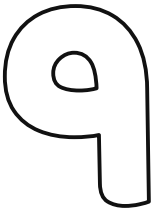
6
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six



7
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8
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nine

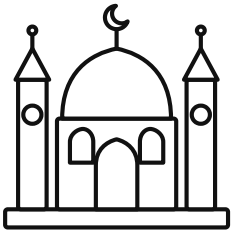
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LET'S TALK

My first Kashmiri words گوڈنِکی لَفظ

Now that you know the letters, try saying these with your family.

السلام علیکم	*assalaamu alaikum* **Peace be upon you (the Muslim greeting)**
وعلیکم السلام	*va alaikum assalaam* **And upon you be peace (the reply)**
میون ناو چھُ ...	*myon naav chhu ...* **My name is ...**
شُکریہ	*shukriya* **Thank you**
جزاک اللہ خیراً	*jazaakallaahu khairan* **May Allah reward you with good**
مأج · مول	*moj · mol* **Mother · Father**
بوے · بیٚنہِ	*boy · beni* **Brother · Sister**
آ · نَہ	*aa · na* **Yes · No**
بہٕ چھُس کأشُر ہیچھان!	*bi chhus koshur hechhaan!* **I am learning Kashmiri! (a girl says: bi chhes ... hechhaan)**







REFERENCES & SOURCES

Where our facts come from

[1] **The Noble Qur'an** — Surah Ar-Raḥmān 55:1–4, Surah Ar-Rūm 30:22 and Surah Al-Ḥujurāt 49:13. Arabic text and meanings checked against **Quran.com**; the English meanings in this book are simplified for children.

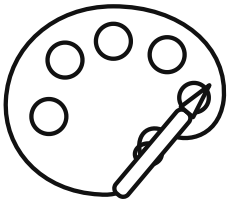
[2] **Map** — outlines from **Natural Earth** (public domain), via the *world-atlas* data set.

[3] **Language facts** — speaker numbers from **Ethnologue** (SIL International), rounded.

What's next?
You have met all **37 Kashmiri letters**! Keep practising by reading signs, books and food packets written in Kashmiri, and look out for the other books in the **Allamahul Bayan Series**, in shā' Allāh.

Enjoyed this book?
A short review on Amazon helps other families find it — *jazākumullāhu khayran!*







Certificate of Achievement

ماشاءالله! شاباش!

maashaa-allaah! shaabaash! — Well done, bravo!

This certifies that

_____

has learned, traced and colored
all 37 letters of the Kashmiri alphabet.

Date _____ Grown-up's signature _____

Minhaz Reza

Hafez Abdullah Muhammad Minhaz Reza, author

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